StoryCast: Research and Planning

Design files: https://www.figma.com/design/gd9w4Tud8Ndn10p4WmwVnF

Purpose

StoryCast is a 3 page site to create short audio and video stories. Many story sites do not provide captions and/or transcripts until late, and even when they may not have complete ones. Every story is published by StoryCast to be read, watched, and heard from the beginning.

Audience

- Captions and transcripts are required for Deaf or hard-hearing persons.
- Screen reader users require well-defined regions, logical heading structure, and labels on controls.
- For keyboard-only users, have a logical tab order and a focus indicator.
- Those who are unable to play sound can read along and click on a line of a transcript to go to it.
- Users of small screens require easy-to-reflow and fast-to-load layouts.

Similar sites

I checked out NPR and The Moth. Player and title information appear on their story page first, transcripts can be hard to locate, and linked stories stay the reader's attention. StoryCast assigns all stories their own section and connects all stories together. (Include screenshots dated before submission.)

Information architecture

Site hierarchy

Home :

Story pages: The last ferry of the night (audio) and The market of stolen shadows (video)

About and access :

The main navigation (top) and footer (bottom) of every page provide links to the other pages. There's also a breadcrumb to Home on each story page and a link to the other story.

Heading hierarchy

Home: h1 page title, h2 Featured stories (h3 for each story card), h2 Listen your way

Story: h1 story title, h2 transcript, h2 Related stories (h3 for the related story)

About: h1 About and access, h2 Our mission, Accessibility features, Keyboard shortcuts, Get involved

All pages share the same header, nav, main and footer. Story pages include article, aside and figure.

Design choices

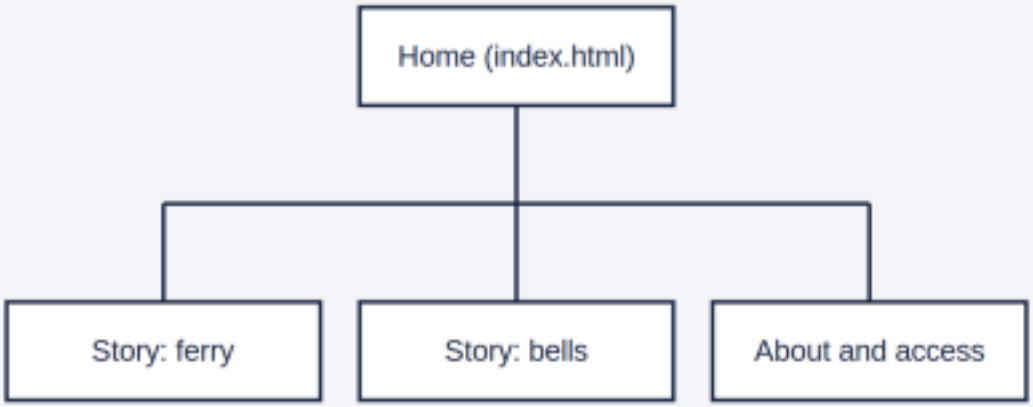
- Colour: navy text on cool grey background, teal for links/buttons, and 1 yellow accent for active transcript line, and focus ring.
- The typestyle should be serif for body text, sans-serif for headings, and controls.
- Style: flat surfaces, the thin borders and real photos are the personalities.
- The steps are: structure, then grayscale wireframes, then colour mockups in Figma, and then the build.

Where to find things

Sitemap: docs/sitemap.svg and Figma page "Sitemap and hi-fi mockups".
Wireframes: The "Wireframes" page in Figma.

The “Sitemap and hi-fi mockups” page in Figma is a high-fidelity mockup.Figma page “Sitemap and hi-fi mockups” is a high fidelity mockup.

Sitemap



Stories also link to each other (related) and back to Home. All pages share the main nav.